



Learn About Investment Options

While the SEC cannot recommend any particular investment product, a vast array of investment products exists, including stocks (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/stocks>) , mutual funds (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/mutual-funds-and-exchange-traded-funds-etfs>) , corporate and municipal bonds (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/bonds>) , annuities (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/annuities>) , exchange-traded funds (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/exchange-traded-funds-etfs>) (ETFs), money market funds (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/money-market-funds>) , and U.S. Treasury securities (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/bonds#Treasuries>) .

Stocks, bonds, mutual funds and ETFs are the most common asset categories. These are among the asset categories you would likely choose from when investing in a retirement savings program or a college savings plan. Other asset categories include real estate, precious metals and other commodities (</introduction-investing/basics/investment-products/commodities>) , and private equity. Some investors may include these asset categories within a portfolio.

Investments in these asset categories typically have category-specific risks.

Before you make any investment, understand the risks of the investment and make sure the risks are appropriate for you (</research-before-you-invest/research/assessing-your-risk-tolerance>) . You'll also want to understand the fees (</research-before-you-invest/research/understanding-fees>) associated with the buying, selling, and holding the investment.

[Gauge Your Risk Tolerance \(/introduction-investing/investing-basics/save-and-invest/gauge-your-risk-tolerance\)](/introduction-investing/investing-basics/save-and-invest/gauge-your-risk-tolerance)

[Up \(/Introduction-Investing/Investing-Basics/Save-And-Invest\)](/Introduction-Investing/Investing-Basics/Save-And-Invest)